NAACP's *Crisis*, saw such movement as indicative of larger stories of African American experiences in the nation: "The autobiography of Angela Davis begins—complex and paradoxical. It is the story of a black woman born in the South, and educated in the world's finest institutions who remained bound to her roots. … It is also a collective biography—of black life in white America."[93] Her border crossing was seen as exceptional and a vehicle for growing identifications among people.

In the ensuing years, Davis would return to East Berlin habitually, making at least three trips, in 1972, 1973, and 1975, enshrining her role as a dissident American Berliner.[94] From her first trip to her last, she went from being a young graduate student to a hugely popular and celebrated public icon. During an official state visit in September 1972, soon after her acquittal, she was greeted by tens of thousands of East Germans, some of whom had written letters and sent telegrams on her behalf to the judge presiding over her case, to officials in California, and to Davis herself. Höhn and Klimke note that *Time* magazine referred to the atmosphere at the time as "Angelamania." Like Paul Robeson before her, East German general secretary Erich Honecker bestowed her with a Great Star of Friendship among the Peoples (fig. 2.3). She was also given tours of historic sites to much fanfare, including Soviet sites of mourning such as the Soviet War Memorial in Treptower Park and Neue Wache on Unter den Linden. Official state publications and photographers captured her movements and appearances in large public gatherings. Davis returned to East Berlin several times after 1972. In 1973, she was a featured guest at the Tenth World Festival of Youth and headed the American delegation. She also returned in 1975 for the World Congress of Women and in 1981 for the Children and Youth Sports Festival. Through this time, she finished her doctoral studies through East Berlin's Humboldt University.